HR ANALYTICS DASHBOARD TOOLKIT

Employee and recruiting analytics for modern HR teams

Welcome

Welcome to the **HR Analytics Dashboard Toolkit** built by **Xpantra**.

Thank you for your purchase. This toolkit was designed to help HR professionals, founders, and small business teams gain clear insights into their workforce and recruiting performance without needing an expensive HRIS platform.

By combining the simplicity of Excel with the powerful visualization capabilities of Power BI, this toolkit allows you to transform everyday HR data into interactive dashboards and actionable insights. Instead of manually reviewing spreadsheets or building reports from scratch, you can instantly analyze key workforce metrics and monitor recruiting performance in one centralized dashboard.

This toolkit was built to give HR teams the power of modern analytics without requiring expensive HR software or advanced technical skills.

With just Excel and Power BI, you can track workforce trends, monitor recruiting performance, and quickly answer the questions leaders ask most often.

Welcome to **Xpantra**, and enjoy building smarter, data-driven HR processes.

What This Dashboard Helps You Answer

The HR Dashboard helps HR teams quickly answer important workforce questions such as:

• How many employees do we currently have?
• Which departments have the highest turnover?
• What is our average employee tenure?
• How long does it take to fill open roles?
• Which recruiting stages slow down hiring?

Instead of manually analyzing spreadsheets, this dashboard provides instant insights into workforce trends.

Toolkit Contents

Excel files: • Employee_Data.xlsx • Recruiting_Data.xlsx	Pre-built Excel spreadsheets for tracking key HR metrics such as employee data, recruiting pipelines, and relocation expenses.
Power BI Dashboard Template: • HRDashboard.pbit	A customizable Power BI template that connects to the Excel trackers and visualizes the data in interactive dashboards.
Documentation	Includes a Start Here setup guide, instruction sheets inside each Excel tracker, and FAQ resources within the dashboard to help you set up, manage, and use the toolkit effectively.

System Requirements

Before you begin, ensure that your system meets the following requirements:

- **Microsoft Excel:** Version 2016 or later.
- **Microsoft Power BI Desktop:** Latest version recommended (free download from Microsoft).

- **Operating System:** Windows 10 or later (**macOS):** Power BI Desktop is designed for Windows. Mac users may need a Windows environment (such as Parallels or Bootcamp).
- **Internet Connection:** Required for downloading Power BI Desktop and refreshing data.

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First Time Setup

Follow the steps below to connect your Excel data and open the HR Analytics Dashboard for the first time.

Step 1: Save the Toolkit Folder

After downloading the toolkit ZIP file:

- [ ] Extract the folder to your computer.
- [ ] Save the folder somewhere easy to access.

Important:

You can rename the folder and Excel files if you want.
However, do not change the column headers or Excel table names inside the files, as the dashboard depends on these.

Step 2: Add Your HR Data

- [ ] Open the Excel tracker files included in the toolkit:

Employee_Data.xlsx
Recruiting_Data.xlsx

These spreadsheets are where your HR data will be stored and maintained.

- [ ] Enter or paste your employee and recruiting information into the appropriate columns.

You may safely:

- *Add new rows of data*
- *Update employee information*
- *Add recruiting activity and candidate records*

*To ensure the dashboard continues to work correctly, **do not:***

- *Rename column headers*
- *Rename Excel tables*
- *Delete required columns*

- [ ] Once your data has been entered, **save and close the Excel files**.

This Excel file will be the file you continuously use to manage and update your HR data going forward.

Step 3: Download Power BI

The HR Analytics Dashboard is built using Microsoft Power BI Desktop, a free data visualization tool used to create interactive dashboards.

If you do not already have Power BI installed on your computer, follow the steps below to download and install it.

Download Power BI Desktop

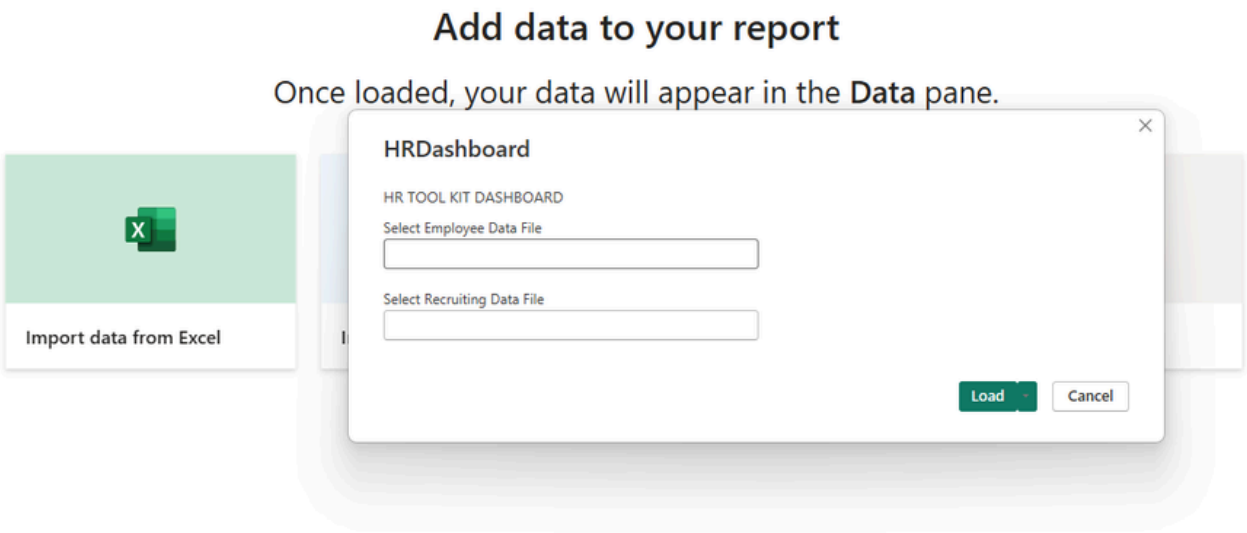
1. Open your web browser.
2. Go to the official Microsoft Power BI download page: https://powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/
3. Click Download Free.
4. This will redirect you to the Microsoft Store page for Power BI Desktop.
5. Click Install.
6. Once the installation is complete, open Power BI Desktop from your computer.

Step 4: Open the Dashboard Template

☐ Open the Power BI template file included in the toolkit:

HRDashboard.pbit

When the template opens, Power BI will prompt you to provide the file location of your Excel trackers. As shown in the figure below.



Step 5: Connect Your Excel Files

- [ ] Locate your Excel files on your computer:

Employee_Data.xlsx
Recruiting_Data.xlsx

- [ ] Right-click each file and select Copy as path.
- [ ] Paste the file path into the Power BI prompt when asked for:

Select Employee Data File
Select Recruiting Data File

- [ ] Once both file paths are entered, click Load.

Power BI will now connect to your Excel data and automatically build your HR analytics dashboard.

Important

Sometimes Windows adds quotation marks around the file path when copying it. If this happens, remove the quotation marks before clicking Load.

Correct format

C:\Company\HR Analytics\Employee_Data.xlsx

Incorrect format

"C:\Company\HR Analytics\Employee_Data.xlsx"

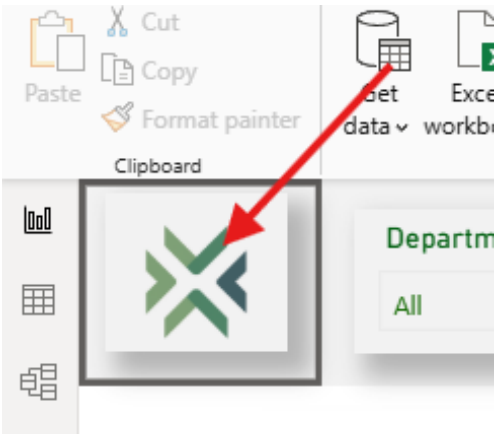
Step 6: Explore the Dashboard

After loading completes, your dashboard will appear.

You can now:

- ☐ View workforce analytics
- ☐ Analyze recruiting activity
- ☐ Filter charts and visuals
- ☐ Explore your HR insights

☐ To reset all filters, click the Reset Dashboard button.



Note: When using Power BI Desktop, hold Ctrl + Click when pressing dashboard buttons.

Step 7: Refresh Data

Whenever you update your Excel trackers:	☐ Save the Excel files ☐ Open the Power BI dashboard ☐ Click **Refresh**

Your charts and metrics will update automatically.

Sample Data and Example Views

You can preview how the toolkit works using the sample data and example screenshots included in the download.

Inside the **Sample Data and Examples** folder, you will find example images showing how the Excel trackers and Power BI dashboard should appear when the toolkit is fully populated with data.

These examples are helpful if you want to:

- Understand how the trackers should look when filled out
- Preview the dashboard visuals before entering your own data
- Compare your data layout to a working example

Refer to these sample images if you are unsure whether your data is formatted correctly.

Using Excel Trackers

Important Rules

You may safely:

• Add new rows of data
• Update employee information
• Add recruiting activity and candidate records

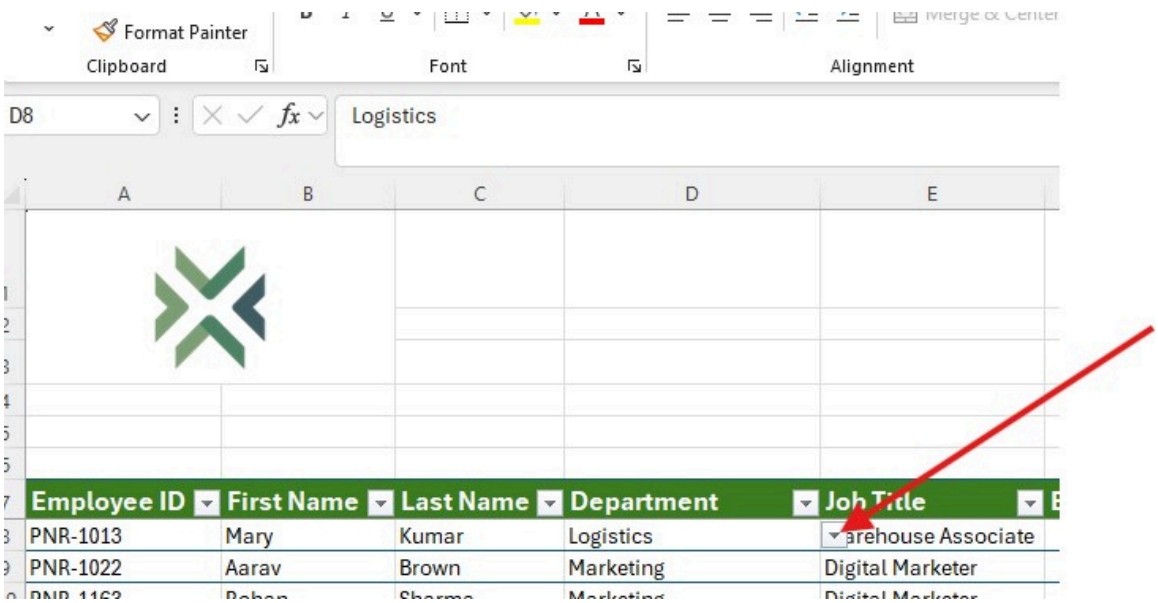
To ensure the dashboard continues to work correctly, ***do not:***

• Rename column headers
• Rename Excel tables
• Delete required columns

The Excel tracker files included in this toolkit are used to store your HR data. The Power BI dashboard reads these files to generate analytics and visualizations.

Follow the examples below when entering or updating your data.

Using Dropdown Menus



Several columns in the Excel trackers include **dropdown menus** to help standardize your data.

To use a dropdown menu:

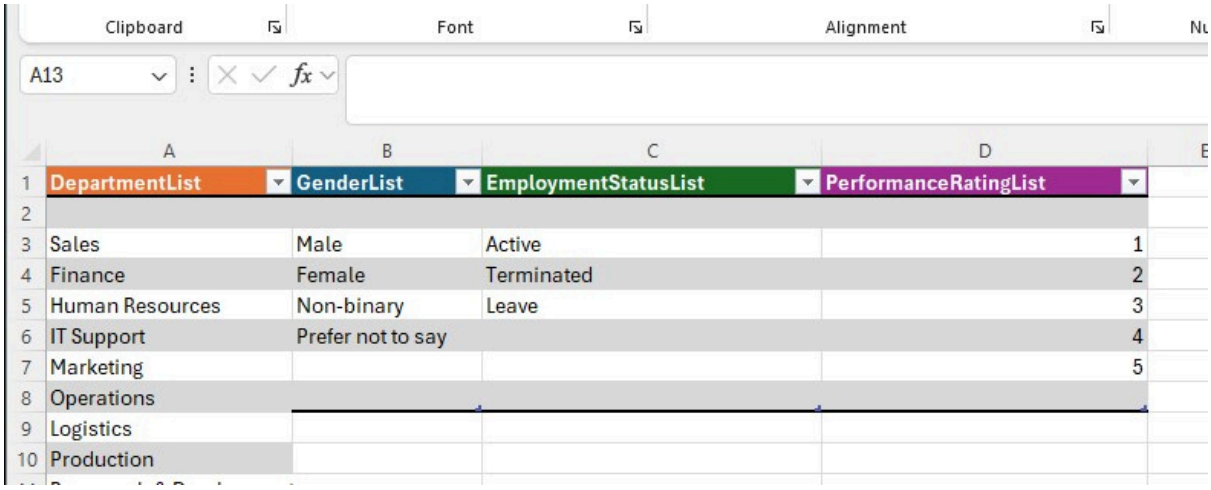
1. Click the cell in the column.
2. Click the **dropdown arrow** on the right side of the cell. (Shown in figure above)
3. Select the appropriate value from the list.

Using dropdown menus helps ensure your data remains consistent and allows the dashboard to group and analyze information correctly.

Examples of dropdown fields may include:

- Department
- Employment Status
- Performance Rating
- Gender

Updating Dropdown List Values



	A	B	C	D
1	DepartmentList	GenderList	EmploymentStatusList	PerformanceRatingList
2				
3	Sales	Male	Active	1
4	Finance	Female	Terminated	2
5	Human Resources	Non-binary	Leave	3
6	IT Support	Prefer not to say		4
7	Marketing			5
8	Operations			
9	Logistics			
10	Production			

Dropdown menu options are controlled by the lookup tables in the Excel file.

If your organization uses different values, you can update these lists.

To modify a dropdown list:

1. Locate the lookup table in the spreadsheet.
2. Add or edit the values in the list.
3. Save the Excel file.

The dropdown menus in the tracker will automatically update to reflect the changes.

Calculated Columns

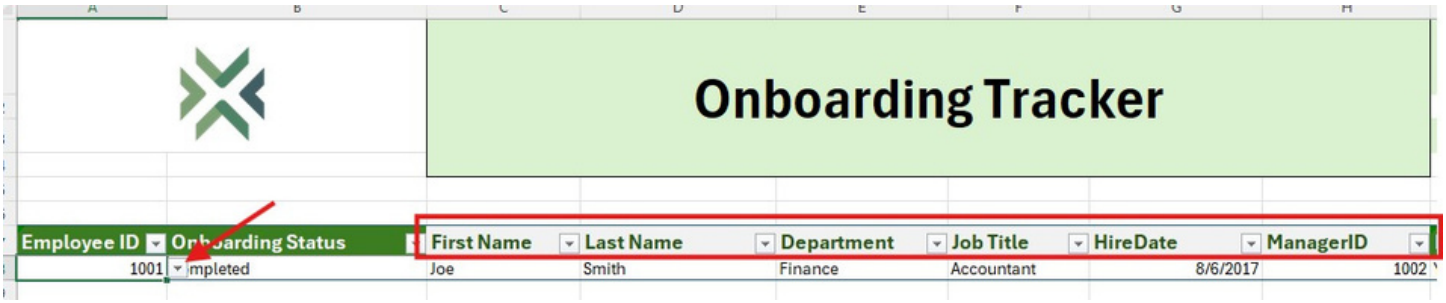
	Employment Status	TenureYears	TerminationFlag
2	Active	3.2	1
4	Active	3.2	1
3	Active	4.7	1
4	Active	3.2	1

Some columns in the tracker are automatically calculated using Excel formulas. These columns are in red font with a grey background.

Important:

Do **not enter or modify data in these columns**. The formulas will calculate the values automatically.

Onboarding Tracker



Each row in the Onboarding Tracker corresponds to an employee listed in the “Employees” sheet.

The connection between the two sheets is made using the **Employee ID** column.

When you enter or select an **Employee ID,** the tracker automatically retrieves related employee information from the Employees sheet. (Shown in Figure above)

This ensures that onboarding records always match the correct employee.

Updating Onboarding Status

The primary field you will update in this sheet is the **Onboarding Status** column.

Examples of onboarding status values may include:

- Not Started
- In Progress
- Completed
- Delayed

Updating this field allows the dashboard to track onboarding progress and identify employees who may still have outstanding onboarding tasks.

Best Practices

To keep the onboarding tracker working properly:

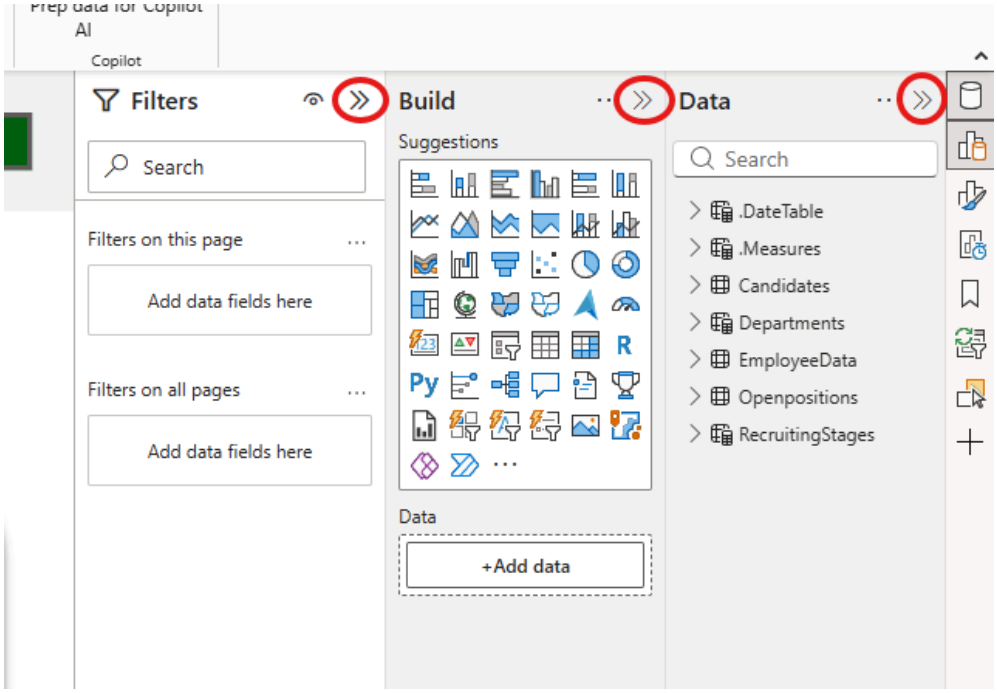
- Always select or enter a valid **Employee ID**
- Do not modify the grey formula columns
- Add new rows only at the bottom of the table
- Ensure the employee exists in the **Employees sheet** before adding onboarding records

Using and Navigating the Dashboard

The HR Analytics Dashboard is interactive and allows you to explore your workforce and recruiting data in multiple ways. You can filter information, navigate between dashboard pages, and interact

with charts to explore trends and insights.

Create the Best Viewing Experience



When opening the dashboard in Power BI Desktop, several editing panels may appear on the right side of the screen.

For the best viewing experience, collapse these panels.

This will expand the dashboard canvas and allow you to focus on the visuals without the editing interface.

Using Dashboard Filters

The dashboard includes dropdown filters at the top of the page to help you focus on specific groups of data.

Common filters include:

- Department
- Work Location

The dashboard visuals will automatically update based on your selection.

Navigating Dashboard Pages

The dashboard contains multiple pages designed for different HR insights.

Examples include:

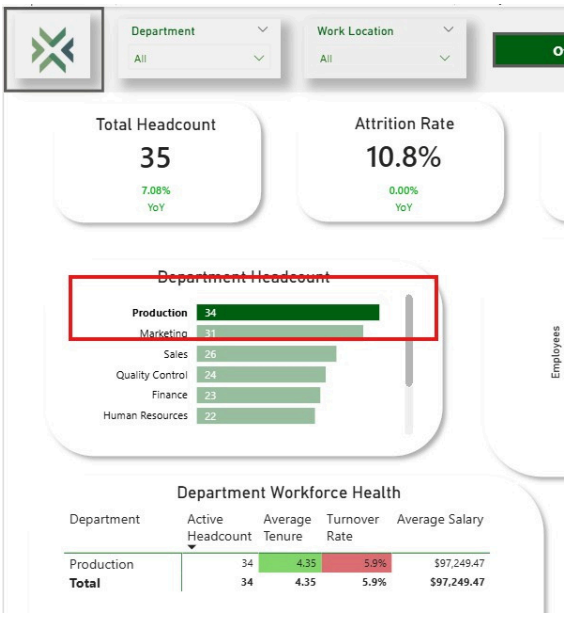
- Overview
- Payroll
- Recruiting
- FAQs

To navigate between pages, click the page buttons at the top of the dashboard.

Important

When using Power BI Desktop, you must hold **Ctrl + Click** when selecting navigation buttons.

Interacting With Dashboard Visuals



Charts and visuals on the dashboard are connected. When you click on a data point in a visual, the rest of the dashboard will automatically filter based on that selection.

Example:

If you click the “Production” bar in the Department Headcount chart, all other visuals on the page will update to display metrics only for the Production department.

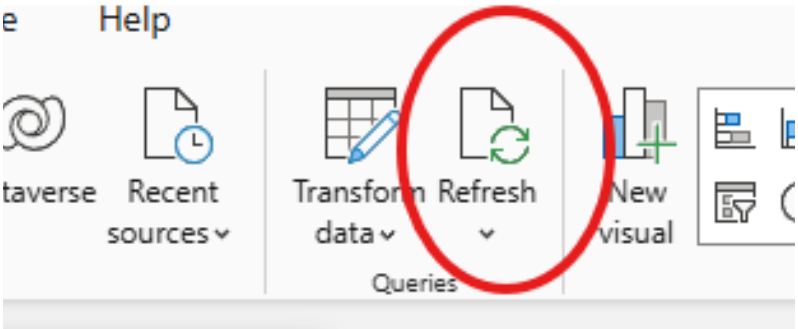
To clear the selection, simply click the visual again or reset the dashboard filters.

Refreshing Data and Syncing Your Data in Power BI

The HR Analytics Dashboard reads data directly from the Excel tracker files included in this toolkit. When you update the Excel files, you will need to refresh the dashboard so Power BI can reload the latest information.

Refreshing ensures that all charts, metrics, and visuals reflect your most current HR data.

How to Refresh the Dashboard



To refresh your dashboard:

1. Open your Power BI dashboard file.
2. Locate the **Refresh** button in the top toolbar.
3. Click **Refresh**.

Power BI will reconnect to the Excel files and update all visuals in the report. This process typically takes only a few seconds depending on the size of your dataset.

When Should You Refresh?

You should refresh the dashboard whenever changes are made to your Excel trackers.

Common examples include:

- Adding new employees
- Updating employee information
- Recording employee terminations
- Adding new recruiting candidates
- Updating recruiting stages or job statuses

Refreshing the dashboard ensures your HR analytics stay accurate and up to date.

Best Practices

- [ ] Always save your Excel files before refreshing Power BI
- [ ] Keep your Excel trackers in the same folder location
- [ ] Avoid renaming Excel table names or column headers
- [ ] Refresh the dashboard after major updates

Troubleshooting

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
Dashboard does not update after refreshing	Excel file changes were not saved	Save the Excel tracker files and click **Refresh** again in Power BI
Power BI cannot find the Excel file	File was moved, renamed, or folder location changed	Reopen the Power BI template and provide the correct file path for the Excel tracker
Dashboard shows blank visuals	Filters may be applied or data may be missing	Clear filters using the **Reset Dashboard** button or review your Excel data
Some charts appear incorrect	Data entry inconsistency in Excel	Verify dropdown selections and confirm values follow the lookup list
Refresh fails or shows an error	Power BI temporarily lost connection to the Excel file	Close Power BI Desktop and reopen the dashboard, then refresh again
New employees or candidates do not appear	Data was added but dashboard not refreshed	Save the Excel file and click **Refresh** in Power BI
Dropdown values not appearing in Excel	Lookup list may not contain the value	Add the value to the **Lookup Table** and save the Excel file
Dashboard navigation buttons do not work	Power BI Desktop requires a special click command	Hold **Ctrl + Click** when selecting navigation buttons
Dashboard view feels too small	Power BI editing panels are open	Collapse the **Filters, Build, and Data panels** on the right side
Data appears outdated	Dashboard has not been refreshed recently	Click **Refresh** to sync the latest Excel data

If you are unsure whether your files are formatted correctly, compare them to the sample images provided in the Sample Data folder.

Need Help?

If you experience any issues or have questions about setting up or using the dashboard, we are here to help.

For support or questions, please contact:

Xpantrahr@gmail.com

When reaching out for support, it can be helpful to include:

- A short description of the issue
- A screenshot of the problem if possible
- The step where the issue occurred

This allows us to assist you more quickly.